

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8 6 5

♥ 10

♦ 9 8 5 2

♣ 8 6 4 2

♠ A J 3

♥ 7 6 4

♦ K J 6

♣ A Q 10 7



♠ 7 4 2

♥ A K 3

♦ A Q 7 4

♣ K J 3

♠ K Q 10

♥ Q J 9 8 5 2

♦ 10 3

♣ 9 5

West

North

East

South

1NT

2♥

6NT

All Pass

6NT by North

Next play off your 4 ♦ winners, discarding a small ♥ from your hand.

You are now zeroing in on East.

Play the ♣K, ♣J, then over to your ♣Q.

[showcards N:S7,S4,HA,H3 E:S9,S8,S6,C8 S:SA,SJ,H7,CA W:SQ,ST,HJ,H9]

Here is the layout after the 3 ♣ plays. Everybody followed suit except East who discarded a ♥ (unhappily, it seemed).

When you now play your ♣A, discarding a ♠ from dummy, East is squeezed.

If he discards the ♠10, then his ♠Q will fall underneath your ♠A, establishing your ♠J.

But if he instead throws the ♥9, both of dummy's ♥s will become winners.

North is to play 6NT. East leads the ♠K.

You have 11 winners; 1 ♠, 2 ♥s, 4 ♦s and 4 ♣s. If you can make a trick with the ♠J all will be well. But if not, as long as East holds the ♠Q, which is almost a certainty, you will be able to squeeze him in ♠s and ♥s.

The first thing you should do is to duck the ♠K. If East foolishly plays another ♠ your troubles are over. But he doesn't, he plays the ♥Q instead which you win with dummy's ♥K.

Even though East didn't play a second ♠ your first round duck served a very important purpose - it rectified the count for your squeeze.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 8
♥ K Q J 9 6 3
♦ 10 4
♣ 7 6 3

♠ A K Q 6

♥ 7 4 2

♦ K Q J 7

♣ K 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 9 4 3

♥ 5

♦ 8 6 5 2

♣ J 10 9 4

♠ 7 5 2

♥ A 10 8

♦ A 9 3

♣ A Q 8 2

West	North	East	South
			1 ♣
2 ♥	Dbl	Pass	2NT
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			
6NT by South			
♠s.			

East now holds the the only guard in ♠s.

Play the ♦ A, then ♦ K Q.

East will follow to all three ♦ s.

Now for the squeeze. Play dummy's ♦ J and discard your ♥ 10.

If East discards the ♠ J you will cash dummy's ♠ 6, then win the last 3 ♣ tricks.

So East will no doubt throw a ♣ instead. In which case you win the last 4 ♣ tricks.

Squeezes are so very satisfying.

South is to play 6NT. West leads the ♥ K.

As usual, you have 11 winners; 3 ♠s, 1 ♥, 4 ♦ s and 3 ♣s. If ♠s split 3-3 dummy's ♠ 6 will become trick #12. If ♠s don't split though, you will have the chance of a squeeze if the defender with long ♠s also has 4 or more ♣s.

For a squeeze to operate you will need to lose one trick and the time to do that is right now. Let West hold the ♥ K and win his ♥ continuation with your ♥ A.

East discarded a ♦ on the second ♥.

You might as well find out about the ♠s right now. Play the ♠ A K Q.

Too bad, West discards a ♥ on the third round of

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ J 9 8 6 4

♥ 9 5 3

♦ 10

♣ J 8 6 3

♠ A

♥ J 7 4

♦ A K J 9 7 5

♣ A 7 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 10 7 3

♥ K Q 10 6

♦ 3 2

♣ 10 9 5

♠ Q 5 2

♥ A 8 2

♦ Q 8 6 4

♣ K Q 2

West

North

East

South

1♦

Pass

2NT

Pass

4♦

Pass

5♦

Pass

6♦

All Pass

6♦ by North

Now play ♦Q, ♦J, ♦9. Discard the ♠5 from dummy on the third ♦.

[showcards N:SQ,HA,H8 E:SJ,S9,H9 S:HJ,H7,D7 W:SK,HQ,HT]

East could afford to throw 2 ♠s and a ♥ on your ♦ plays.

But when you play the ♦7 he is squeezed.

He cannot dump his ♠K because you would throw the ♥8 and dummy would be high.

So he will discard the ♥10 instead. At this point you know that the ♠Q is worthless so you discard it. You win the final two tricks with the ♥A and ♥J.

North is to play 6♦. East leads the ♥K.

You have 11 winners; 1 ♠, 1 ♥, 6 ♦s and 3 ♣s.

At first things look hopeless, but remember this is a lesson on squeeze plays. From the opening lead you know that East must hold the ♥Q. If he also holds the ♠K you will be able to squeeze him in ♥s and ♠s.

You let the ♥K win, (hoping he will play another ♥), but he plays a small trump instead which you win in your hand.

Pull one more round of trumps, then unblock the ♠A.

Then take your 3 ♣ winners, ending in your hand.